Haidi Martinidou

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Neuroscience graduate (BSc Glasgow, MSc King's College London) working toward a PhD in computational neuroscience. Combines quantitative training on large clinical and population datasets with hands-on patient-facing research experience.

RESEARCH INTERESTS

My research centres on the mechanisms underlying maladaptive decision-making and mood dysregulation, particularly reward processing, prediction-error signalling, and reinforcement learning across healthy and clinical populations. This thread connects my past work on fairness-based decision-making and diet-related depression risk. I am also interested in subtler, non-clinical disruptions to self-regulation, including procrastination, optimism, and hormonal influences on cognition. I approach these mechanistic questions as a route toward identifying targets for intervention.

EDUCATION

MSc Psychology and Neuroscience of Mental Health (Merit) 2021 – 2023
King's College London, UK

BSc (Hons) Neuroscience (2:1) 2018 – 2021
University of Glasgow, UK
Advanced entry; Class Representative, 2020–2021.

EXPERIENCE

Affiliate Researcher and Research Intern Jul 2026 – present
University of Glasgow, School of Medicine, Dentistry and Nursing (Glasgow and remote)

- Supervisor: Dr Ourania Varsou. Supporting an evaluation of the University of Glasgow–AAUP medical exchange programme for students studying in conflict-affected settings: entering and verifying questionnaire data, organising consent records and participant documentation.
- Wrote the codebook, documented missing-data decisions, and built an analysis-ready workbook; running the quantitative analysis in R (demographics, descriptive statistics, composite scores, ranking analyses).
- Developed the qualitative reflexive thematic analysis (Braun and Clarke) from scratch: coding framework, themes, audit trail and coding matrices, integrated with the quantitative findings.
- Wrote a literature review and publication strategy, and drafted the manuscript's Methods, Results and Discussion and an internship report. On-site week in Aug 2026 included shadowing imaging-phantom development and observing MRI scanning.

Independent Research Project — EEG Analysis (OpenMIIR) 2026 (ongoing)

- Self-directed, four-stage EEG pipeline on the OpenMIIR music-imagery dataset: preprocessing, stimulus predictor modelling, TRF encoding, and a generative predictive-coding simulation.
- Using IDyOM to derive per-note surprise and entropy values as predictors of the EEG response to heard and imagined melodies; preprocessing and acoustic predictor stages complete, symbolic (IDyOM) modelling stage in progress.
- Reproducible, version-controlled codebase, built and maintained independently alongside formal coursework.

Patient Supporter (Fieldwork) Nov 2024 – Feb 2026
IQVIA, Global Perspectives, Athens

- Ran end-to-end participant recruitment for pharma-sponsored, non-interventional studies across roughly 20 therapeutic areas, including rare disease: first contact, eligibility screening, DocuSign e-consent, diagnosis verification, scheduling and participant payments.
- Held 500+ conversations with patients and caregivers across 10+ projects, acting as recruitment lead on several.
- Led recruitment and outreach for a study on VEXAS syndrome: sourced collaborators in the US, including the NIH group that first described the condition, engaged patient organisations in the US and UK, and worked with supporting neurologists.
- Handled sensitive health data under clinical governance and GDPR (PII redaction, adverse-event reporting, study documentation and tracking). Recognised internally as "Excel and AI Champion".

Merchandise Coordinator and Neuroscience Advisor (remote) Aug 2024 – Nov 2024

MindHug, London

- Managed end-to-end merchandise operations for workshops across 6 UK universities: sourcing, supplier coordination, budgeting and on-time delivery to events.
- Partnered with the lead psychologist to audit workshop slides and materials, translating neuroscience concepts into clear language for student audiences.

Clinical Observership — rTMS Jul 2024

NovelBrain, Greece

- Prepared a review of recent rTMS literature for the clinical team, then observed the clinic's rTMS protocol.

HR Coordinator Oct 2023 – Oct 2024

Caffeine Roastery SuperFoods, Thessaloniki

- Built the HR function from the ground up at launch (recruitment, onboarding, core policies) for a team of 10.
- Designed and ran structured interviews and onboarding, drawing on motivation and person–role fit.

Master's Dissertation — Reward, Risk, and Fairness Processing 2022 – 2023

King's College London

"The Connection Between Processing Fairness and Reward-Risk Prediction in the Human Brain"

- Narrative synthesis screening over 350 papers and synthesising 10 in depth, across fMRI, EEG, PET, TMS, and tDCS.
- Concluded that reinforcement-learning prediction-error mechanisms underpin social decision-making, linking reward computation to processes usually studied separately in the fairness literature.
- Supervisor: Dr Gisele Dias.

Undergraduate Dissertation — Diet and Depression Risk 2020 – 2021

University of Glasgow

"The Association Between Mediterranean Diet and Depression Risk"

- Analysed UK Biobank data (N = 502,359) using binary logistic regression in Stata, testing six Mediterranean-style dietary components (oily and non-oily fish, fruit, salad and raw vegetables, cooked vegetables, processed meat) against self-reported depression.
- Used stepwise adjustment for age, sex, smoking, medication, area deprivation, education and month of assessment; small protective associations persisted, largest for oily fish (OR 0.90). Now being prepared as a manuscript.
- Supervisor: Dr Donald Lyall.

Living Support Assistant Sep 2019 – Jun 2020

University of Glasgow, Kelvinhaugh Residences

- Overnight on-call welfare cover (18:00–07:00) for student residents, responding to emergencies including mental-health crises and safety incidents.
- Ran wellbeing check-ins and mediated flat conflicts; trained in Mental Health First Aid, First Aid, Fire and Life Safety, and mediation. Role ended due to COVID-19.

SKILLS

Research and data: R (basic: descriptive statistics, regression, composite scores); Python (basic: MNE-based EEG preprocessing in the OpenMIIR pipeline); IBM SPSS; Stata; Excel (advanced); questionnaire data management and codebooks; reflexive thematic analysis; systematic literature screening and narrative synthesis; digital brain atlas tools (QuickNII, MeshView); running IDyOM (Common Lisp).

Software: DocuSign, Notion, Obsidian, ClickUp, Canva Pro, Adobe Premiere, SoftOne, Microsoft Office, GitHub Pages.

Certificates: Mental Health First Aid, First Aid, Fire and Life Safety (University of Glasgow, 2019); adverse-event reporting and compliance training (IQVIA).

Languages: Greek (native); English (fluent); French (basic, learning).

Music and arts: Choir, Filippos Glee, Athens (2025–2026); jazz singing lessons; lead singer with local bands, including a fundraising concert (2016–2019); Megaro Mousikis Thessalonikis choir (2011–2014); violin, Conservatory of Northern Greece (2008–2014; lead violin 2012, awards of excellence); theatre training, Andreas Voutsinas drama school (2007–2014).

INDEPENDENT PROJECTS

- ForFun (2026) — Designed and launched an application-tracking web app for programmes, jobs and grants, with a freemium AI search feature (Next.js, Supabase).
- VibeDeck (2026) — Turns a described "vibe" into a playlist via the Spotify API and an LLM; deployed to Cloudflare Workers.
- Personal sites (2025 – 2026) — Academic site and blog (Jekyll, GitHub Pages) and a hand-built art portfolio (haidiartin).

SCIENCE COMMUNICATION

- Why GenAI Models Make Things Up — GenAI Unpacked (YouTube, Dr O. Varsou): wrote the episode on AI hallucinations; 1,600+ views, 2025
- Contributing writer on neuroscience, AI, social commentary and modern history — Parallaxi Magazine, 2023 – 2026
- The human brain and Silicon Valley — Parallaxi Magazine, March 2024
- Do, re, mi, we got emotional: what Coldplay did in Athens — Parallaxi Magazine, June 2024
- Odd Things: essays on neuroscience and behaviour, e.g. a neuro-computational account of procrastination — Personal website and LinkedIn, 2025 – 2026

COURSES

- IMB9345: Neuroscience Data Integration through Use of Digital Brain Atlases — University of Oslo, Faculty of Medicine (Neural Systems Laboratory, EBRAINS), Sep 2026 (online PhD-level elective, 2 ECTS)

PUBLICATIONS

- Varsou O., Walters M., Martinidou H., et al. Evaluation of the University of Glasgow–AAUP medical exchange programme: a transferable framework (working title). In preparation.
- Martinidou H., Lyall D. M. Mediterranean-style dietary components and self-reported depression: a cross-sectional analysis of 502,506 UK adults in the UK Biobank cohort. In preparation; preprint planned.
- Martinidou H., Theotokis P. Review on how sustained AI use may reshape brain networks (working title). In preparation for Current Issues in Molecular Biology (MDPI), special issue "Neural Networks in Molecular and Cellular Neurobiology".

CONFERENCES

- NeuroMonster Conference — Rome, June 2026
- Greeks in AI 2026 Symposium — Athens, 15–17 July 2026
  - Opening talk, "Foundational research in the time of AI" — Dr Christos Papadimitriou
  - NeuroAI panel — Constantine Dovrolis, Leontios J. Hadjileontiadis, Maria Papadopouli, Alexandros Potamianos, Stelios Smirnakis, Nektarios Tavernarakis
- Neuroscience conferences, Royal College of Physicians and Surgeons of Glasgow — Glasgow, 2018, 2019

REFERENCES

- **Dr Ourania Varsou** — University of Glasgow. Supervisor, affiliate research post and AAUP exchange-programme study. Email on request.
- **Dr Donald Lyall** — University of Glasgow. BSc dissertation supervisor. Email on request.